

The Ottoman Empire

Between 1300 and 1699, the Ottoman Turks conquered a vast empire, which stretched from North Africa to the Indian Ocean. At the empire's height, more than 35 million people lived under Ottoman rulers, called sultans.

KEY (c.1566)



Goods coming into the empire



Furs
Luxurious furs were bought from icy Russia.



Slaves
Slaves did many jobs, from paperwork to guarding the sultan.



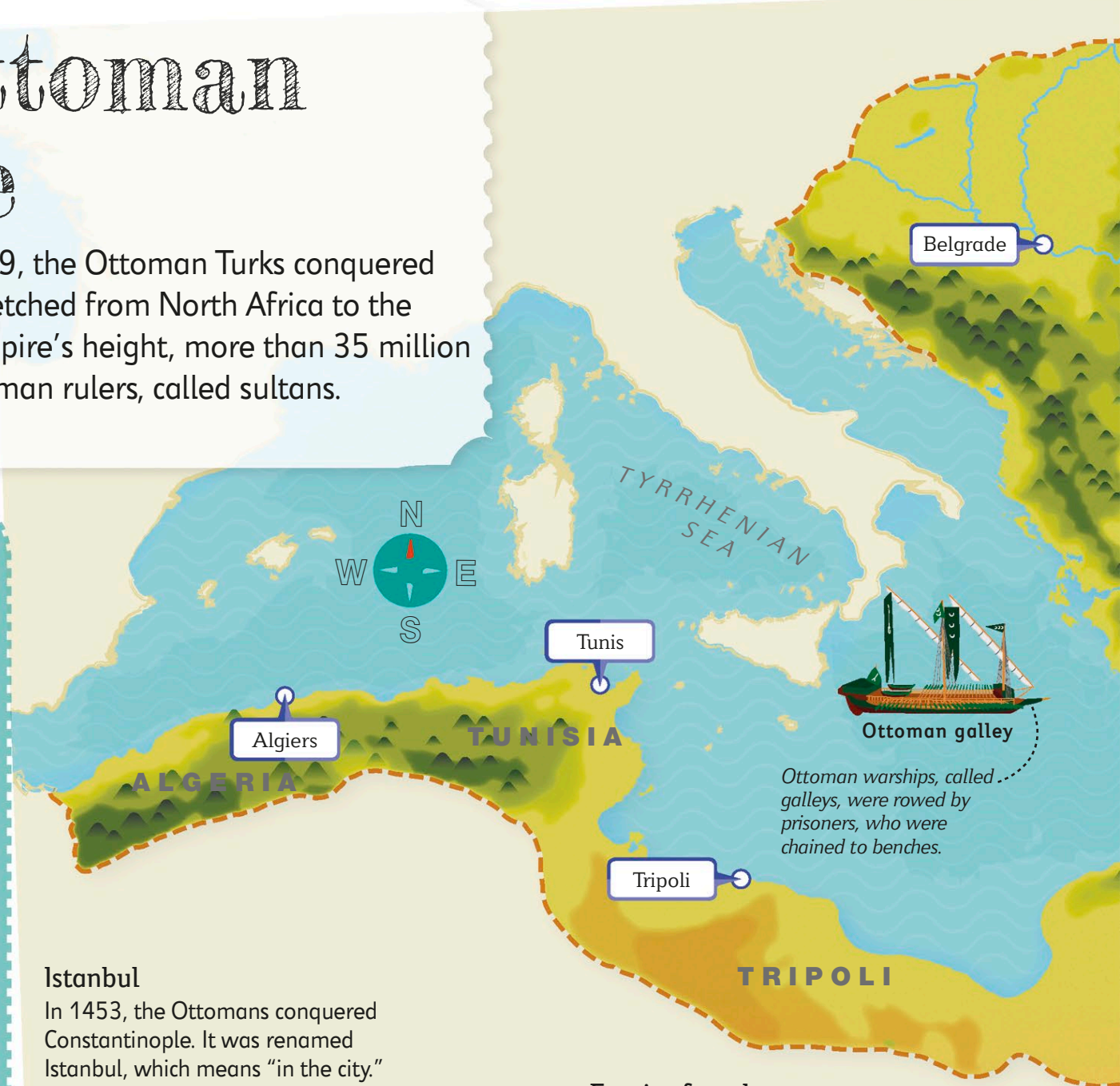
Spices
Used to flavor food.



Incense
Burning incense released perfume.



Silk
Raw silk was made into fine cloth.



Istanbul

In 1453, the Ottomans conquered Constantinople. It was renamed Istanbul, which means "in the city." Istanbul's Blue Mosque was built by Sultan Ahmed between 1609 and 1616.

Empire founder

The word "Ottoman" comes from the name of the first ruler, Osman I. He founded a small state in northern Anatolia in the early 1300s.



Osman I, ruled 1299–1324

The Blue Mosque

